

Giant Recycled Table Sets World Record

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On September 12, 2026, about 20,000 people gathered in Bucharest, Romania. They shared a meal at a very long table called the "Uniting Table." The table stretched 3.1 miles, or 4.99 kilometers. It set a new Guinness World Record for the longest table made from **recycled** materials.

But the world record was only part of the goal. A **nonprofit** group called Bloom The World organized the event. It also raised more than \$110,000 for Romania's first **psychiatric** hospital for children. This is a hospital that provides mental health care.

Children in Bucharest who need this care are currently treated in an old facility. It has large, crowded **wards** with little **privacy**. The new hospital is planned to open in 2027. It will care for children with conditions such as depression, autism, and ADHD.

This was the second time Bloom achieved this record. In 2025, the group brought together 10,000 people around a 1.7-mile table made from **recycled** materials. That event was in Alba Iulia, Romania. It focused on bringing people together and raising environmental **awareness**.

Bloom plans to recycle the materials from the latest table again. This time, they will be used to make children's furniture.

Word Treasure

recycled -- Processed so materials can be used again.

nonprofit -- An organization that works for a purpose rather than to make money for owners.

psychiatric -- Related to care for mental health conditions.

wards -- Areas in a hospital where patients receive care.

privacy -- Having personal space away from other people's view.

awareness -- Knowing about and understanding something.

Break it down

Introduces the community meal and the table's world record.

Explains the fundraiser and the planned children's hospital.

Describes the group's earlier record in 2025.

Ends with the plan to recycle the table into children's furniture.

Why it matters

The meal brought people together, raised money for children's mental health care, and used materials that Bloom plans to recycle again.

Test what you remember

1. Where did people gather for the 2026 meal?

- ☐ (A) At a furniture shop
- ☐ (B) Bucharest, Romania
- ☐ (C) Alba Iulia, Romania
- ☐ (D) At the new hospital

2. What record did the Uniting Table set?

- ☐ (A) The largest collection of children's furniture
- ☐ (B) The most meals served in a hospital
- ☐ (C) The longest table made from recycled materials
- ☐ (D) The longest table made from new materials

3. Which group organized the event?

- ☐ (A) The new hospital
- ☐ (B) Guinness World Records
- ☐ (C) A furniture company
- ☐ (D) Bloom The World

4. What was the money raised for?

- ☐ (A) A factory making recycled tables
- ☐ (B) A children's mental health hospital
- ☐ (C) A park in Alba Iulia
- ☐ (D) A new community dining hall

5. When is the new hospital planned to open?

- ☐ (A) In 2026
- ☐ (B) In 2025
- ☐ (C) In 2024
- ☐ (D) In 2027

6. What does Bloom plan to make from the latest table's materials?

- ☐ (A) Playground paths
- ☐ (B) Children's furniture
- ☐ (C) Community signs
- ☐ (D) Hospital uniforms

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: C 3: D 4: B 5: D 6: B

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):